

Vitchakorn Poonyakanok, MD, MS

Physician & Clinical Data Analyst

Pittsburgh, PA, USA
✉ vk.poonyakanok@gmail.com
🌐 vitchakorn.com
📞 vpoonyak
📄 vitchakorn
🆔 0009-0007-9945-0376
👤 Google Scholar

Professional Profile

Physician-technologist working at the intersection of frontline clinical practice and data science — a bridge between the two worlds. I turn clinical and public-health problems into working software and analytics: a deployed altitude-risk decision-support app ([altit.app](#)), field outbreak investigations, predictive clinical models, and edge-AI health devices. I bring clinical credibility to data and engineering teams, and engineering rigour (ML, data governance, interoperability, cybersecurity) to health systems.

Education

- Aug 2026 – **M.S., Health Care Analytics and Information Technology (MSHCA)**, *Heinz College, Carnegie Mellon University*, Pittsburgh, PA, USA, Royal Thai Government (Department of Disease Control, DDC) scholarship
May 2028
Expected graduation: May 2028. Focus: health system analytics, data governance, and information systems.
- Aug 2025 – **M.S., Digital and AI Technologies in Health Systems (DigiHealth)**, *Faculty of Medicine & Faculty of Engineering, Chulalongkorn University*, Bangkok, Thailand
Jul 2026
Focus: digital health architecture, clinical AI applications, interoperability, and medical databases.
Independent study: *Development and Evaluation of an AI-Assisted Altitude Extraction System from Travel Itineraries for Travel Medicine* (advisor: Assoc. Prof. Watcharapong Piyaphanee, M.D.).
- Jun 2024 – **Residency Training in Preventive Medicine (Travel Medicine)**, *Institute of Preventive Medicine, DDC, Ministry of Public Health (MOPH)*, Nonthaburi, Thailand
Jul 2026
Focus: preventive medicine, travel risk assessment, vaccinology, and health security; field outbreak investigation with DDC Joint Investigation Teams.
On planned academic leave from Aug 2026 to undertake the MSHCA at Carnegie Mellon; residency to resume on return.
- Apr 2013 – **Doctor of Medicine (MD)**, *Faculty of Medicine Ramathibodi Hospital, Mahidol University*, Bangkok, Thailand
Jul 2019
Clinical rotations across Internal Medicine, Surgery, Pediatrics, OB-GYN, and Emergency Medicine.
International clinical elective via the IFMSA SCOPE exchange — Hospital Clínico Universidad de Chile, Santiago (2017).
- 2010 – 2013 **Upper Secondary School (Science-Mathematics Program)**, *Triam Udom Suksa School*, Bangkok, Thailand

Work Experience

- Nov 2024 – **Medical Officer, Professional Level — Preventive & Travel Medicine**, 🏢 *Office of Disease Prevention and Control 6 (ODPC 6), DDC, MOPH, Pattaya, Chon Buri, Thailand*
Jul 2026
 - Deliver pre-travel risk assessment, yellow-fever vaccination/certification, and prophylaxis counselling; apply self-built clinical tools (e.g. altitude-risk analysis) at the point of care.
 - Serve as site physician for the WHO Enhanced Gonococcal Antimicrobial Surveillance Programme (EGASP), contributing standardized surveillance data.On academic leave from Aug 2026 for the MSHCA at Carnegie Mellon.

- Jun 2022 – **General Practitioner, 🏢 Bamrasnaradura Infectious Diseases Institute, Nonthaburi, Thailand**
- May 2024 ○ Led outpatient and Acute Respiratory Infection (ARI) clinic services through major COVID-19 and mpox outbreak responses.
- Analyzed 32,084 ARI-clinic visits (26,669 patients; Mar 2022 – Aug 2023) in Python — arrival hour was the dominant bottleneck ($r = -0.41$; ~ 121 min mean service time for 07:00 arrivals vs ~ 44 min at 14:00; weekends/holidays 15–21 min slower, ANOVA $p < 0.001$) — and presented scheduling recommendations to department leadership.
- Delivered vaccinology counselling and designed clinical safety protocols for staff.
- Jul 2020 – **Medical Officer, Practitioner Level, 🏢 Si Songkhram Hospital, Nakhon Phanom, Thailand**
- Apr 2022 ○ Managed general, emergency, and inpatient medical services at a 60-bed community hospital.
- Sep 2019 – **Medical Officer, Practitioner Level, 🏢 Nong Khai Hospital, Nong Khai, Thailand**
- Jul 2020 ○ Completed clinical rotations in emergency medicine, pediatrics, surgery, and OB-GYN at a ~ 350 -bed provincial general hospital.

Publications & Outbreak Investigations

- Peer-reviewed **An Investigation of MMR-Related Mumps Cluster Following Immunization Among Practical Nursing Students, Bangkok, Thailand, 2024.** S. Lertsakulbunlue, D. Srithammavong, K. Tepsittha, H. Kanjanasombut, V. Poonyakanok, et al. *Journal of Tropical Medicine* 2025;2025:9974081. (5th of 16 authors; field outbreak investigation)
- In preparation **First Confirmed Case of Ceftriaxone Non-Susceptible *Neisseria gonorrhoeae* in Thailand: Outbreak Investigation and Public Health Response in Pattaya, 2025.** Manuscript in preparation. (MIC 0.25 $\mu\text{g/mL}$, 2024 CLSI; identified at the ODPC 6 EGASP sentinel site. DDC Joint Investigation Team — field investigation and active case finding; manuscript review)
- In preparation **An Investigation of Mumps Outbreak in a Secondary School, Saraburi Province, Thailand, August–September 2025.** T. Prasongsil, W. Saowong, V. Poonyakanok, et al. Manuscript in preparation. (co-author; DDC Joint Investigation Team field investigation — retrospective cohort & Firth’s logistic regression)
- Surveillance evaluation **Evaluation of the Syphilis Surveillance System, ODPC 6, Pattaya, Chon Buri, Thailand (Jan–Jun 2025).** Assessed the national Digital Disease Surveillance (DDS) system’s attributes — sensitivity, predictive value positive, timeliness, and representativeness — and recommended improvements. (co-investigator; preventive-medicine residency study)
- Surveillance report **Preliminary Investigation and Rapid Response to a Methanol Intoxication Outbreak Linked to Illegal Herbal Liquor in Bangkok, August 2024.** C. Jitpeera, W. Rongdech, K. Raruenroeng, V. Poonyakanok, et al. *Weekly Epidemiological Surveillance Report (WESR)*, 2024. (co-author; rapid outbreak response)

Honors & Awards

- Jul 2026 **2nd Place (Silver Award), Track B — Digital Health Innovation Competitions, BRIDGE-AI Summit 2026,** Faculty of Medicine, Chulalongkorn University (with Weill Cornell Medicine) — 2nd of 15 teams in the Medical AI category (60 graduate & medical-resident teams across four categories), for the AI-assisted altitude-extraction work behind [altit.app](#).

Applied AI & Technical Training

- Apr – Jun 2026 **Super AI Engineer Season 6, Artificial Intelligence Association of Thailand (AIAT), Thailand, Advanced AI Level 2** — selected as one of 157 from 10,457 applicants
- **Coffee Chain Demand Forecasting Hackathon:** Private Kaggle Rank #1 / 2nd Runner-up overall (of 30 teams) — leakage-aware time-series pipeline with gradient boosting and robust cross-validation.
- **Parasite Eggs Object Detection Challenge:** Ranked 16/166 — cascaded microscopy detector using SAHI, YOLOv8, and a DINOv2 classification head.
- **Edge-AI Intelligent Transport System Hackathon:** Co-Honorable Mention — real-time CCTV edge analytics on Jetson Nano (YOLO/ONNX Runtime).
- **WellSense AIoT Product Hackathon:** Academic Popular Vote — wearable running-posture monitor (Arduino Nano 33 BLE Sense, TinyML/Edge Impulse, BLE, React dashboard).
- **Agentic Pipeline Hackathon (2026 Thai Election OCR):** Ranked 102/571 — OCR pipeline for hand-written election reports.

Selected Projects

Deployed tools

- **DDS Chatbot** ([live demo](#)) — guardrailed Thai disease-surveillance LLM assistant for the DDC: answers epidemiology questions via LLM tool-calling over an aggregate, PII-free data mart, behind a six-layer, PDPA-aligned guardrail stack. Hardened via a 753-turn authorized red-team and stress-testing session — prompt-injection, system-prompt-extraction, and destructive-query attacks — with live hot-fixes cutting attack success from ~25% to ~1% in-session; 99.8% pass on a 3,819-run secure regression benchmark; presented to the DDC Division of Epidemiology (Jun 2026).
- **Altitude Itinerary Analyzer** ([altit.app](#)) — full-stack clinical decision support web app that parses and analyzes multi-modal travel itineraries for high-altitude sickness risk assessment; 84.9% altitude-extraction accuracy within ± 100 m on text itineraries in the thesis benchmark (2nd Place, BRIDGE-AI Summit 2026).
- **Thai HospSearch** ([hoscode.vercel.app](#)) — in-browser lookup over ~174K MOPH-coded records (44K health facilities, 42K schools, 77K villages) across Thailand's 13 health regions, 77 provinces, and 7,436 subdistricts, for administrative coding and records checking; rebuilt from MOPH APIs.
- **Hajj Menstrual Delay Planner** ([hajj-period-planner.vercel.app](#)) — clinical utility for planning pharmaceutical menstrual suppression for female Hajj pilgrims.

Data science

- **Cirrhosis Survival Prediction** ([Kaggle](#)) — multi-class survival model using ensemble learning (XG-Boost/LightGBM).
- **Outpatient Waiting Time Analysis** ([Kaggle](#)) — ANOVA and Random Forest on hospital logs to pinpoint bottlenecks and forecast wait times.
- **Sichuan-Yunnan Altitude & Transit Map** ([GitHub](#)) — QGIS geospatial visualization for Acute Mountain Sickness risk along the Sichuan-Yunnan highway.

Dashboards

- **Tableau: PM2.5 & Mental Health Dynamics** (with Interrupted Time Series), **Yellow Fever & Malaria Prevention**, and **Thai EPI Vaccine Dashboard** (prototype).

Certifications

Security & Cloud

- TPQI × Huawei — **AI Literacy Power Users & Cloud Developer Level 5** — 2026.
- **ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)** — Mar 2026–Mar 2029.
- Huawei Cloud HCCDA — **Tech Essentials & AI** — Apr 2026–Apr 2029.
- **Cybersecurity Foundation Course**, Thailand National Cyber Academy — 2024.
- **Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate** — 2024.

Data & AI

- **Super AI Engineer** — **AI Practitioner Certification (Level 1)**, AIAT — 2026; includes **Foundation AI (Theory)**, **From Data to Insight**, and the **FahMai RAG & Agentic Pipeline** hackathons.
- **Google AI Essentials V1** — 2024.
- **Certified Professional Data Analyst**, DataRockie Bootcamp 9 — 2024.
- **Google Advanced Data Analytics Professional Certificate** — 2023.
- **Data Visualization with Tableau Specialization**, UC Davis — 2023.
- **Excel Level Up Update 2021**, SkillLane — 2023.
- **Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate** — 2023.

Medical & Research

- **CITI Program Biomedical Researchers** — Jan 2025–Jan 2029.
- **Introductory Course in Epidemiology & Biostatistics**, DDC MOPH — 2024.
- **ISTM Review Course**, International Society of Travel Medicine — 2024.
- **Diploma in Clinical Epidemiology**, Chiang Mai University — Sep–Dec 2022.
- **Diploma in Clinical Statistics**, Chiang Mai University — Feb–May 2022.

Licensure & Registration

Medical License, Thai Medical Council — full registration since 2019.

Authorized Seafarers' Medical Examiner, Office of Maritime Labour, Thailand — 2026; authorized to issue seafarers' medical certificates.

Tour Leader License, Department of Tourism, Thailand — 2025.

Professional Memberships

HIMSS (Healthcare Information and Management Systems Society) — member since 2026.

Technical Skills

Programming & Statistics: Python, R, SQL, STATA

Machine Learning & Data Science: Scikit-Learn, gradient boosting & stacked ensembles (XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost), AutoGluon (AutoML), Chronos (time-series), PyTorch, YOLO, OpenCV, Pandas, NumPy, Jamovi

LLM & Generative AI: Claude, GPT, Gemini, GLM, Grok, and ThaiLLM APIs; RAG and agentic pipelines

Visualization & Geospatial: Tableau, Looker, Power BI, Matplotlib, Seaborn, QGIS, Adobe Photoshop, Inkscape

Software, Cloud & Hardware: Git, Firebase, Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Huawei Cloud, Arduino, TinyML, UML

Environments & HPC: Colab, Jupyter, Anaconda, Linux, LANTA HPC

Clinical Data & Interoperability: data interoperability, data governance, medical record systems

Languages & Interests

Languages Thai (Native); English — Proficient (TOEFL iBT 91/120, Duolingo English Test 120/160).

Medical Travel medicine, preventive vaccinology, emerging infectious diseases.

Technical Public health informatics, clinical machine learning, geospatial disease mapping, healthcare cybersecurity.

Personal Scuba diving (PADI Rescue Diver), photography, trekking, and travel.